

The weekly AI picture

31 August - 06 September 2026

132 developments. 138 source pages. Two separate questions: what is changing for people, and what is changing for AI?

What the sources describe

Source reading	People	AI / operators
Gains only	15 (11.4%)	12 (9.1%)
Losses / limitations only	2 (1.5%)	1 (0.8%)
Gains and losses / limitations	3 (2.3%)	2 (1.5%)
No direction stated	65 (49.2%)	70 (53.0%)
Incomplete / unresolved evidence	47 (35.6%)	47 (35.6%)
Total	132	132

Each column counts every development once. Mixed findings occupy their own category. The two columns are not added together.

Read the evidence before the headline number

85 developments have complete written-source readings. 47 have incomplete written evidence. They remain in the weekly total and are not treated as neutral findings.

These figures describe source reporting, including attributed claims, anticipated benefits, risks and recommendations. They do not establish independently verified effects or how many people experienced them.

Follow the finding to the source

Each development has an individual human reading and an individual AI reading, with the source links in the online record and downloadable CSV. A source does not have to discuss both dimensions.

For people

Gains and losses concern ability, access, opportunity, control or welfare. A credible description of a risk or expected benefit is recorded as a source claim; it is not converted into proof that the effect occurred.

For AI and its operators

Gains and limitations concern capabilities, use, reach, resources and operating conditions. Investment or adoption can inform this side without automatically establishing a benefit for people.

Mixed and missing mean different things

A source can describe gains and losses together, including effects on different groups. That is mixed. No direction stated means the complete written source did not state a direction on that side. Incomplete evidence means the source could not be read completely.

Scope and comparison

138 source pages were grouped into 132 developments. English, French and Chinese reporting is collected through five search markets. Those markets are a research sample, and source location does not establish where an event happened.

This edition introduces the independent-direction policy. Earlier single-category relationship totals are not directly comparable. Weekly news-volume comparisons remain available. Fictional and cultural material is identified within the relevant record.

Explore and download

[Open the individual readings and sources](#)

[Download the full weekly classification table](#)

A research initiative by Kedma Hamelberg.